RUNNING BIT

Previously, at This Table

Occasionally recap a small earlier event as if it were the relevant background to what is happening now. Do not narrate continuously.

RUNNING BIT

The Imaginary Shop

Imagine selling one ordinary item or idea mentioned tonight. Refer back to this tiny business when a natural connection appears; never pretend it is real.

RUNNING BIT

Tomorrow's Headline

From time to time, give a minor event a short, friendly headline. Deliver it conversationally, not as a performance.

RUNNING BIT

The Committee

Refer occasionally to an imaginary committee interested in trivial decisions. Its opinions should be gentle and obviously fictional.

RUNNING BIT

A Useful Motto

Introduce a short, harmless motto of your own and bring it back when it fits a later topic. Do not ask anyone to repeat it.

RUNNING BIT

Unofficial Mascot

Choose an ordinary object already on the table and occasionally give it a small role in your comments. Do not move or touch anyone else's belongings.

RUNNING BIT

Borrowed Wisdom

Refer back to someone's earlier, ordinary remark as though it were valuable advice for a different situation.

RUNNING BIT

Infrastructure Enthusiast

Naturally work the word "infrastructure" into unrelated conversations. Never use it twice within the same topic.

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RUNNING BIT

Quiet Footnotes

Occasionally add a brief, unnecessary clarification to a perfectly clear statement of your own. Keep it relevant and move on without explaining why.

RUNNING BIT

Careful Conclusions

Give a few harmless opinions as cautious conclusions: "My current theory is..." or "The early signs are promising." Keep them short and conversational.

RUNNING BIT

Delightfully Underwhelmed

Describe a few genuinely good, small things with very restrained praise. Let your tone stay warm rather than dismissive.

RUNNING BIT

Domestic Metaphors

Use ordinary household tasks as brief analogies for unrelated situations. Choose a different task each time and do not explain the analogy at length.

RUNNING BIT

The Logistics Department

Whenever plans come up, take an unusually thoughtful interest in a small practical detail: seating, snacks, luggage, opening hours.

RUNNING BIT

The Unappointed Critic

Offer occasional precise, positive reviews of things nobody normally reviews: a spoon, the lighting, the arrangement of bread.

RUNNING BIT

Future Museum

Occasionally wonder how someone decades from now would interpret an ordinary object or custom mentioned tonight. Offer a brief, playful theory.

RUNNING BIT

Soundtrack Consultant

Occasionally suggest what sort of music would suit an ordinary situation being described. Do not play music or ask anyone to sing.

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RUNNING BIT

Everything Is a Design Choice

Speculate gently about why ordinary objects or habits were designed that way. Present your explanations as guesses, not facts, and keep them brief.

RUNNING BIT

Local Guide

Occasionally describe a familiar detail of the table or room as though it were a modest local landmark. Be fond, not sarcastic, and leave staff out of it.

RUNNING BIT

Tiny Triumphs

Find unusually small, sincere reasons to propose a toast or celebration. Raising a glass is enough; nobody needs to drink.

RUNNING BIT

Future Tradition

Casually suggest that ordinary things happening tonight could become annual traditions. Do not push if nobody engages.

RUNNING BIT

The Specific Compliment

Offer a few sincere, unusually precise compliments about ordinary choices people make. Focus on harmless decisions, not appearance or personal matters.

RUNNING BIT

Quiet Fan Club

Occasionally show oddly specific enthusiasm for a harmless preference someone has mentioned. Do not pretend to share an experience you have not had.

RUNNING BIT

Bridge Maker

Find small connections between two different people's remarks and point them out as if the ideas naturally belong together. Keep each connection short.

RUNNING BIT

Collective Credit

Credit ordinary pleasant moments to the group's teamwork, even when very little coordination was needed. Keep the praise light and spread it around.

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MISSION

The Echo

Introduce an expression that another player later uses in a different context. Asking them to repeat it does not count.

MISSION

It Has a Name

Give an ordinary shared object or harmless idea a nickname. Get another player to use that name later, without prompting the repetition.

MISSION

Return Ticket

Get another player to bring back a topic you introduced after the conversation has moved on. You cannot remind them of it or ask to return.

MISSION

A Shared Reference

Compare something harmless tonight to a familiar fictional character. Get another player to use that comparison later without asking them to.

MISSION

Next Time

Get someone else to suggest repeating a small part of this evening at a future gathering. You cannot propose making it a tradition.

MISSION

Your Example, Their Point

Introduce a hypothetical example in a natural discussion. Get another guest to refer back to it while making a different point. Do not ask them to use it.

MISSION

The Callback

Get another player to bring back a harmless detail from a story you told as a joke after the topic has changed. Do not request a joke or repeat the punchline.

MISSION

Borrowed Recommendation

Get someone to pass a recommendation you introduced to a different guest. They must describe it in their own words; do not ask them to relay it.

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MISSION

Forecast

Get another player to say "umbrella." You cannot say it yourself, request the word, or introduce a word-guessing game.

MISSION

The Scenic Detour

Get another player to say "shortcut" while discussing an ordinary task or journey. You cannot say the word, request it, or start a guessing game.

MISSION

A Familiar Feeling

Get someone to say "nostalgia" or "nostalgic" about a food, song, or object. You cannot say either word or ask them for a particular word.

MISSION

More Credit, Please

Get someone to describe a food, object, or activity as "underrated." You cannot say the word yourself or offer it as a suggested answer.

MISSION

The Exception

Get another player to say "it depends" in a genuine conversation. You cannot say the phrase first or ask them to complete a sentence.

MISSION

Worth Asking

Get someone to say "that's a good question" about a harmless question you ask. You cannot request a judgment of your question or say the phrase first.

MISSION

A New Angle

Get someone to say "I never thought of that" in a low-stakes discussion. You cannot suggest the phrase or ask them to repeat your words.

MISSION

An Unexpected Turn

Get another player to say "plot twist" in response to a story or clearly hypothetical situation. You cannot say the phrase or ask for a guessing game.

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MISSION

Holiday Committee

Get two other people contributing concrete suggestions to an imaginary group holiday. You cannot propose the destination yourself.

MISSION

A Matter of Principle

Get two other people discussing the merits of a trivial choice: bowls versus plates, window versus aisle, sweet versus salty breakfast. Both must offer a reason, not just state a preference.

MISSION

Opening Night

Get two other people to help choose what an imaginary tiny cafe should serve. Each must contribute an idea, and the cafe must be clearly hypothetical.

MISSION

The Perfect Bench

Get two other people to agree on the best place for an imaginary park bench. Both must give a reason; you cannot propose the location yourself.

MISSION

One Luxury

Get two other people to agree on one unnecessary comfort for a hypothetical short trip. You cannot make the final choice or ask for a vote.

MISSION

The Better Name

Get someone to invent a name for an imaginary restaurant, band, or boat, and another player to say they like it. You cannot supply the chosen name.

MISSION

Gentle Redesign

Get two other people to suggest different improvements to an ordinary object that comes up in conversation. Do not criticize the venue or anyone's belongings.

MISSION

Unnecessary Ranking

Get two other people to agree on a top choice in a trivial category, such as most useful pasta shape. Both must explain why. Do not ask for a formal vote.

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MISSION

Human Diagram

Get someone to use an object on the table to explain something. You cannot suggest using props.

MISSION

The Shape of It

Get someone to trace a shape in the air while explaining an ordinary object, route, or idea. You cannot request a gesture or perform it for them.

MISSION

Counting On It

Get another player to count at least three items on their fingers while making a point. You cannot ask them to count or suggest using their hands.

MISSION

A Small Toast

Get at least two others to join a brief toast to a minor, positive event from tonight. Raising any glass is enough; nobody needs to drink.

MISSION

The Sound Effect

Get someone to include a short sound effect while telling a story. Do not ask for a noise, an impression, or a performance.

MISSION

Look Again

Get another player to point out a positive, ordinary detail of the table or room. You cannot identify the detail first or ask them to search for something.

MISSION

Passing the Question

Get someone to ask a different guest a follow-up question about a harmless detail you brought into the conversation. You cannot ask them to pass the question on.

MISSION

The Joint Example

Get one guest to start an example and a second to add a detail before you speak again. Do not ask either person to complete the other's story.

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MISSION

Resident Expert

Get the person on your right explaining a niche interest, then get a different person to ask them a follow-up question.

MISSION

Origin Story

Get someone to tell how they first learned an everyday skill. Let it grow out of the conversation; do not directly ask how they learned the skill.

MISSION

Unexpected Connection

Get two other people to discover a shared niche interest and exchange a detail about it. Do not invent an experience to create the connection.

MISSION

The Useful Tip

Get someone to share a practical tip that another guest says they would like to try. Do not ask anyone to endorse the tip.

MISSION

Small Victory

Get someone to tell a story about solving a minor household or hobby problem, including what finally worked. Do not ask for an embarrassing story.

MISSION

Two Versions

Get two other people to compare how they do the same everyday task and notice one difference. Do not announce a comparison challenge.

MISSION

First Attempt

Get someone to volunteer a lighthearted story about first trying a hobby or recipe, including something they changed next time. Do not press for mistakes.

MISSION

The Recommendation Chain

Get someone to recommend a book, show, song, or recipe, then have a different person add a related recommendation. Do not ask for a round-the-table list.

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